

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Education Administration English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For school administrators, curriculum coordinators, student-services staff, program directors, admissions teams, registrars, and education operations leaders.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Enrollment, Admissions, and Placement

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Curriculum Planning and Learning Outcomes

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

03 Student Support and Intervention

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

04 Parent and Guardian Communication

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

05 Faculty Coordination and Evaluation

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step.

06 Compliance, Records, and Privacy

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

07 Accreditation and Program Review

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

08 Budget, Staffing, and Institutional Priorities

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Enrollment, Admissions, and Placement

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A family asks why an applicant was not offered a place. The administrator needs to explain the published process without discussing other applicants.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

admissions criteria - The stated requirements used to assess applications for entry to a program.

placement - Assigning a learner to a suitable level or program using relevant evidence.

capacity - Available people, assets, time, space, or system throughput for a given workload.

equity - Fairness in access or treatment; in finance, ownership interest or residual value.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - B. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - C. Could you confirm when does the review start?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - B. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - C. Who will present the report at the meeting?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Explain the applicant's process, not other applicants

Fictional admissions inquiry using the lesson case: a family asks why an applicant was not offered a place; the administrator has not reviewed the applicant-specific decision record.

01 • Family liaison: The family wants to know why their applicant wasn't offered a place. What can we explain?

02 • Admissions officer: First clarify whether they want the published admissions criteria, their decision record, or the review process.

03 • Family liaison: They asked whether another applicant took the place. Should we compare the two applications for them?

04 • Admissions officer: No. We should explain their own process without discussing another applicant's information.

05 • Family liaison: Can we say limited capacity caused the decision, even though we haven't reviewed this applicant's record?

06 • Admissions officer: Not yet. Capacity may be relevant generally, but we must not invent this decision's reason.

07 • Family liaison: I'll ask which part of the process they need clarified and route the applicant-specific question appropriately.

08 • Admissions officer: Good. Use the published process and the authorized record, keeping any unknown reason explicitly unresolved.

09 • Family liaison: That lets us address equity concerns without making unsupported comparisons between children.

10 • Admissions officer: Exactly. I'll identify the appropriate admissions contact so the family receives a clear, individual response.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Language placement is not an admissions decision

Fictional school inquiry: an admitted learner awaits a language-placement review, and a family liaison asks whether admission itself is uncertain.

01 • Family liaison: The learner's placement review is pending. Does that mean the school hasn't admitted them yet?

02 • Enrollment coordinator: In this case admission is confirmed. The pending review concerns the appropriate language-learning group.

03 • Family liaison: Then I should distinguish admission from placement rather than tell the family their place is uncertain.

04 • Enrollment coordinator: Correct. Placement concerns the learning arrangement, while the admissions decision is already recorded here.

05 • Family liaison: Can I promise the advanced group if the family says the learner studied English previously?

06 • Enrollment coordinator: No. That information can support the review, but it doesn't establish its outcome.

07 • Family liaison: What focused question should I ask the placement team before speaking with the family?

08 • Enrollment coordinator: Ask which information remains needed and how the family will receive the reviewed placement decision.

09 • Family liaison: I'll avoid guessing a group or deadline that the team hasn't confirmed.

10 • Enrollment coordinator: Thank you. A clear distinction can reassure the family without promising a placement we don't control.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A waiting-list position is not an offer date

Fictional enrollment discussion: a family has been told their applicant is on a waiting list; no future opening or offer date is confirmed.

01 • School receptionist: The family is on the waiting list. Can I tell them a place will open next month?

02 • Admissions administrator: No opening or offer date is confirmed. Could you clarify whether they are asking about status or likely timing?

03 • School receptionist: They want to plan transport, so an approximate date would help them make arrangements.

04 • Admissions administrator: We can acknowledge that need without inventing availability. Explain that waiting-list status isn't an offer.

05 • School receptionist: Should I ask how many other applicants are ahead and share their circumstances to explain the delay?

06 • Admissions administrator: Use only information authorized by the published process, and don't disclose other applicants' circumstances.

07 • School receptionist: I'll ask the admissions team what status information can be provided for this specific inquiry.

08 • Admissions administrator: Good. Also distinguish confirmed capacity from possible changes that haven't resulted in an available place.

09 • School receptionist: The family will hear that timing remains unknown and receive the correct contact for updates.

10 • Admissions administrator: That is clear and fair, without an unsupported date or comparison with another applicant.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Enrollment, Admissions, and Placement

A family asks why an applicant was not offered a place. The administrator needs to explain the published process without discussing other applicants.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: I can explain the published criteria and the next steps available for this application. Which part of the decision notice would you like me to clarify? I cannot discuss another applicant's record.

Scenario 2 | A transfer request with an unclear start date

A fictional family asks to transfer a learner next term, but the request does not identify the program or whether they mean the first day or a later date. Capacity and placement review are unconfirmed. Clarify the request before discussing availability.

Role A: Enrollment coordinator: ask for the intended program and timing.

Role B: Family liaison: relay the request and identify missing information without promising a place.

Possible opening: Could you clarify which program and start date the family is asking us to consider?

Success checks

- Clarify program and timing separately.
- Keep capacity and placement unconfirmed.
- Agree the next admissions inquiry without an offer promise.

Add a complication: The liaison asks to reserve a place before the program is identified.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Curriculum Planning and Learning Outcomes

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A curriculum plan lists topics but no observable learning outcomes. Teachers disagree about what an assessment should measure.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

learning outcome - A statement of what a learner should be able to demonstrate after instruction.

curriculum map - A plan showing how learning outcomes, teaching, and assessments connect across a program.

assessment - A structured evaluation of needs, performance, evidence, or conditions.

standard - An agreed or authoritative level, specification, or rule used as a reference.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - B. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
 - C. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - B. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?
 - C. How would you describe the next step in your own words?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A topic is not an observable learning outcome

Fictional curriculum meeting using the lesson case: a plan lists topics, but teachers disagree about what the assessment should measure.

01 • Curriculum coordinator: The plan lists persuasive writing. What should learners be able to do that we can actually observe?

02 • Teacher: They should state a clear claim and support it with reasons in a short written argument.

03 • Curriculum coordinator: That is a proposed learning outcome, while persuasive writing is the broader topic label.

04 • Teacher: Then a spelling quiz alone wouldn't show whether learners can support a written claim.

05 • Curriculum coordinator: Correct. The assessment should provide evidence of the outcome we agree, not merely relate to the same topic.

06 • Teacher: Should we place that outcome in the curriculum map and check the relevant program standard?

07 • Curriculum coordinator: Yes. We need to confirm alignment rather than claim the proposal already satisfies an unreviewed standard.

08 • Teacher: I'll bring a sample writing task so colleagues can discuss what evidence it would produce.

09 • Curriculum coordinator: Good. Let's agree the outcome before debating marks for a task that may measure something else.

10 • Teacher: I'll label it a proposal and invite the other teachers to refine the observable performance.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Completing an activity does not prove the outcome

Fictional curriculum review: learners completed a group poster, while the intended outcome is explaining a cause-and-effect relationship individually.

01 • Department head: Every group finished a poster. Can we mark the cause-and-effect outcome as achieved for every learner?

02 • Assessment coordinator: Poster completion is evidence of finishing the activity, not necessarily each learner's ability to explain the relationship.

03 • Department head: So the product and the individual learning outcome aren't the same thing in our curriculum map.

04 • Assessment coordinator: Exactly. The group artifact may contribute evidence, but individual understanding still needs an appropriate check.

05 • Department head: Would a short individual explanation align more directly with the stated outcome than counting finished posters?

06 • Assessment coordinator: That is a useful proposal. Teachers should review its accessibility and criteria before using it.

07 • Department head: I won't describe all learners as having mastered the outcome based solely on group completion.

08 • Assessment coordinator: Good. We can recognize the completed work while keeping the learning claim appropriately bounded.

09 • Department head: I'll bring the proposed explanation task to the team and ask what performance would meet the criterion.

10 • Assessment coordinator: Then the assessment discussion will focus on observable learning rather than completion alone.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Coverage in a curriculum map is not depth of learning

Fictional program review: a topic appears in three units of a curriculum map, but the intended progression between units is unspecified.

01 • Program director: The topic appears in three units. Does that show a clear progression in our curriculum?

02 • Curriculum specialist: It shows repeated coverage, but we haven't specified how the learning outcome develops across those units.

03 • Program director: Could you explain progression in plain English so teachers know what we need to examine?

04 • Curriculum specialist: It means identifying what learners should do with greater complexity or independence at each stage.

05 • Program director: Then repeating the same topic title doesn't establish that later assessments demand deeper understanding.

06 • Curriculum specialist: Correct. We should compare the intended performances and their assessment evidence, not just count map entries.

07 • Program director: I'll ask each unit owner to explain the observable outcome and what prior learning it assumes.

08 • Curriculum specialist: Please also flag assumptions that aren't supported by earlier assessment information.

09 • Program director: That will let us identify possible gaps without claiming learners have failed anything yet.

10 • Curriculum specialist: Exactly. We'll revise the progression proposal after reviewing the actual outcomes and evidence requirements together.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Curriculum Planning and Learning Outcomes

A curriculum plan lists topics but no observable learning outcomes. Teachers disagree about what an assessment should measure.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: A topic says what we cover; an outcome says what learners should be able to do. Let's define those performances first, then check whether the assessment gives learners a chance to demonstrate them.

Scenario 2 | Understand data needs a clearer performance

A fictional unit lists understand data as its learning outcome. Teachers have proposed either reading a chart aloud or explaining a comparison between two values. Neither task is approved. Discuss which observable performance matches the intended learning.

Role A: Curriculum coordinator: ask what understanding should look like.

Role B: Teacher: explain the difference between reading values and interpreting a comparison.

Possible opening: What should learners be able to demonstrate when we say they understand the data?

Success checks

- Distinguish attendance, activity, and learning evidence.
- Propose an observable outcome.
- Keep assessment approval pending the curriculum review.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to treat attendance at the lesson as evidence of achievement.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Student Support and Intervention

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A support meeting has attendance information but no record of which interventions have already been tried.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

intervention - An action intended to change a situation or improve an outcome.

accommodation - An adjustment intended to address a person's access or participation needs.

attendance - A record or measure of presence at a scheduled activity.

student support - Services and actions that help learners participate and progress.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
 - B. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
 - C. Send it no later than Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?
 - B. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - C. Could you confirm that the review is important?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Attendance records do not show previous support

Fictional student-support meeting using the lesson case: attendance information is available, but previously attempted interventions are undocumented.

01 • Support coordinator: We have attendance records. Could you provide the record of interventions already tried before our next meeting?

02 • Class teacher: I don't have a consolidated record. Several colleagues may have offered support without sharing the details here.

03 • Support coordinator: Please ask the authorized staff what was offered, when, and what response was observed.

04 • Class teacher: Should we assume no intervention occurred because nothing appears in this meeting's notes?

05 • Support coordinator: No. Missing documentation doesn't establish no support. We need to clarify the history before proposing another step.

06 • Class teacher: I'll request relevant information through the student-support channel rather than circulate personal details broadly.

07 • Support coordinator: Thank you. Separate an accommodation already agreed from an intervention merely suggested during discussion.

08 • Class teacher: Can I bring gaps explicitly if some colleagues haven't replied before the meeting?

09 • Support coordinator: Yes. State what is verified and what remains unknown so the team can plan responsibly.

10 • Class teacher: I'll bring the available history and avoid making unsupported claims about the student's needs or response.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A suggested check-in has not started

Fictional support review: a weekly student check-in was proposed, but the staff owner and start date were never confirmed.

01 • Year coordinator: The plan mentions weekly check-ins. Could you confirm who is delivering them and when they began?

02 • Support teacher: Those details weren't agreed. The check-in was a proposal, not a support activity already underway.

03 • Year coordinator: Then we shouldn't interpret unchanged attendance as evidence that this intervention failed.

04 • Support teacher: Correct. We don't have confirmed delivery or outcome records for that proposed support.

05 • Year coordinator: Please ask the support lead to clarify ownership, feasibility, and the intended review point before our meeting.

06 • Support teacher: I'll do that. Should I tell the family the check-ins are guaranteed to begin next week?

07 • Year coordinator: Not before staffing and the appropriate agreement are confirmed. We can explain the proposal's current status.

08 • Support teacher: I'll request the decision through the established student-support process and keep personal information appropriately restricted.

09 • Year coordinator: Good. We need a clear action request, not a retrospective claim that an unstarted intervention was ineffective.

10 • Support teacher: I'll return with confirmed arrangements or explicit gaps, so the team can distinguish planning from delivery.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Request evidence about a classroom arrangement

Fictional support discussion: a quieter work location was offered during two lessons; no observation of its effect has been recorded.

01 • Student-support lead: Could you share what was observed when the quieter work location was offered in those two lessons?

02 • Class teacher: The offer is recorded, but I haven't documented whether the learner used it or how it affected participation.

03 • Student-support lead: Please clarify those observations before we describe the arrangement as effective or ineffective.

04 • Class teacher: Would my general impression that the class was calmer count as the learner-specific evidence we need?

05 • Student-support lead: It may be context, but it doesn't establish that learner's use or response to the arrangement.

06 • Class teacher: I'll review my available notes and identify what I can actually support, without reconstructing missing observations.

07 • Student-support lead: Thank you. Keep the request focused on educational participation, not an unsupported diagnosis or explanation.

08 • Class teacher: Can we ask the relevant support professional what further observation would help at the next review?

09 • Student-support lead: Yes, through the established process and with the appropriate privacy boundaries for student information.

10 • Class teacher: I'll bring verified observations and open questions rather than turn a two-lesson offer into a proven outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Student Support and Intervention

A support meeting has attendance information but no record of which interventions have already been tried.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you bring the relevant attendance pattern and the support actions already attempted? We can use those records to plan the discussion and avoid repeating an approach without reviewing its effect.

Scenario 2 | Two staff may be offering the same support

A fictional learner may be receiving similar organizational check-ins from two staff members. The schedule and purpose of each are unconfirmed. Request coordination before adding a third session; do not infer needs or effectiveness.

Role A: Support coordinator: ask for the existing support schedule and purpose.

Role B: Year tutor: identify the relevant staff contacts and keep gaps explicit.

Possible opening: Before adding another session, could we confirm what support is already happening and what each check-in is intended to address?

Success checks

- Request existing support facts before proposing more.
- Avoid assuming effectiveness or duplication is confirmed.
- Agree a privacy-conscious coordination step.

Add a complication: A colleague says more sessions must always be better.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Parent and Guardian Communication

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

SITUATION

A guardian says an email sounded accusatory. The school intended to request a meeting about repeated late arrivals.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

guardian communication - Information exchanged with a student's parent or authorized guardian.

discipline - A process for addressing behavior under an organization's rules; also a field of study.

appeal - A request for a decision to be reviewed through an established process.

confidentiality - Protecting information from disclosure to people who are not authorized to receive it.

3. Notice the language

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Compare this wording: I'm sorry if you failed to understand.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Repair a misunderstanding

4. Check the language

1. Which apology takes responsibility for unclear wording?
 - A. I'm sorry we could not meet the original date.
 - B. I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.
 - C. I'm sorry the process took longer than expected.
2. What should follow an apology for an incorrect date?
 - A. The corrected date and the current confirmation status.
 - B. A longer explanation that never states the correct date.
 - C. A new guaranteed date even if it is unverified.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Replace the accusatory late-arrival email

Fictional guardian communication using the lesson case: a guardian found an email accusatory; the intended purpose was to request a meeting about repeated late arrivals.

01 • Family liaison: The guardian says the late-arrival email sounded accusatory. How should we correct the message?

02 • School administrator: We should acknowledge that wording and state the actual purpose without assuming why the arrivals were late.

03 • Family liaison: Could you give me the revised opening to use when I speak with them?

04 • School administrator: I'm sorry our email sounded accusatory. We would like to discuss the recorded late arrivals and hear your perspective.

05 • Family liaison: That invites discussion instead of presenting a discipline conclusion before the meeting has occurred.

06 • School administrator: Exactly. We should not infer a cause or imply a decision that hasn't been made.

07 • Family liaison: If the guardian asks about an appeal, should I explain a procedure from memory?

08 • School administrator: Refer to the applicable school process and confirm the correct contact rather than inventing procedural details.

09 • Family liaison: I'll keep the conversation focused on their child and protect confidentiality about other students.

10 • School administrator: Thank you. End by agreeing how to arrange the meeting, without making unsupported promises about its outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A group email revealed an individual concern

Fictional communication repair: an administrator sent a meeting request about one learner to a broader staff group than intended; sharing authorization is under review.

01 • Family liaison: The guardian is upset that a wider staff group received the meeting request about their child.

02 • School administrator: I need to acknowledge that concern. The recipient scope is under review, and I won't assume it was appropriate.

03 • Family liaison: What can I say now without promising that every copy has already been removed?

04 • School administrator: I'm sorry the message went to a wider group than intended. We are reviewing its handling through the school process.

05 • Family liaison: Should I describe this as a confirmed legal violation before the responsible reviewer has assessed it?

06 • School administrator: No. Explain the known sending error and review status without making an unverified legal conclusion.

07 • Family liaison: I'll avoid repeating the learner's details while coordinating the response with the authorized privacy contact.

08 • School administrator: Good. We should also clarify the intended meeting purpose separately from the communication problem.

09 • Family liaison: I'll tell the guardian who will follow up and ask which contact method they prefer.

10 • School administrator: Thank you. The corrected response should accept the communication error without inventing the review's outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A pending decision was presented as final

Fictional school exchange: a message described a proposed timetable change as final, although review of a family's concern is still pending.

01 • Family liaison: The family thinks their timetable concern was ignored because our message called the change final.

02 • School coordinator: That wording was incorrect. The proposal is still under review, including the concern they raised.

03 • Family liaison: Please help me explain the correction without promising that the requested timetable will be accepted.

04 • School coordinator: Our earlier message was too definite; the timetable change is proposed, and your concern remains part of the review.

05 • Family liaison: That separates the status correction from an assurance about the eventual outcome.

06 • School coordinator: Yes. We should acknowledge the confusion and give the correct contact for the ongoing discussion.

07 • Family liaison: Should we call their current inquiry a formal appeal, even though they haven't requested that process?

08 • School coordinator: No. Clarify what they are asking and use the school's applicable process rather than assign a label.

09 • Family liaison: I'll ask whether they need clarification or information about available review routes, without discussing other families.

10 • School coordinator: Good. Close with the actual pending status and the next contact, not another unsupported final decision.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Parent and Guardian Communication

A guardian says an email sounded accusatory. The school intended to request a meeting about repeated late arrivals.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Second round: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for scenario 1: I'm sorry the wording sounded accusatory. The purpose is to understand the late arrivals and discuss support. Could we arrange a time to review the pattern and hear your perspective?

Scenario 2 | Urgent sounded like an emergency

A fictional school email used Urgent in its subject for a routine scheduling meeting. A guardian became worried. No emergency or disciplinary decision exists in this case. Correct the wording and agree how to arrange the meeting.

Role A: School administrator: acknowledge the unnecessary alarm and state the routine purpose.

Role B: Family liaison: ask for a clear opening and meeting-arrangement next step.

Possible opening: I'm sorry the subject line caused alarm; this is a routine scheduling discussion, not an emergency.

Success checks

- Acknowledge the sender's wording problem.
- State only the supplied routine purpose.
- Agree a clear scheduling contact without blaming the guardian.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to blame the guardian for misunderstanding the subject.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Faculty Coordination and Evaluation

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step.

SITUATION

Two teachers use different interpretations of the same grading rubric. Students receive inconsistent explanations.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

rubric - A set of criteria and performance descriptions used to assess work consistently.

grading policy - The rules for assigning and explaining assessment results.

observation - Something directly noticed or measured, distinguished from an interpretation.

professional development - Learning activities intended to improve job-related capability.

3. Notice the language

Use a specific example instead of a personality label. Explain its effect, invite the person's perspective, and agree on a practical improvement. Focus on communication that can be changed, not accent or national identity.

In [specific situation], I noticed ...

The effect was ... What was happening from your perspective?

Could we agree to ... and review it ...?

Compare this wording: You are always careless.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give feedback people can use

4. Check the language

1. Which feedback begins with observable behavior?
 - A. The last two updates omitted the agreed completion date.
 - B. The last two updates seemed less professional than usual.
 - C. I think the team needs to be more committed to the updates.
2. Which follow-up invites useful information before agreeing on support?
 - A. Can you promise this will never happen again?
 - B. Would another reminder solve this problem?
 - C. What is making this part of the task difficult?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two rubric interpretations need calibration

Fictional faculty coordination using the lesson case: two teachers interpret the same rubric differently and give inconsistent explanations to students.

01 • Department head: Students received different explanations of the same rubric level. Which interpretation did you each apply?

02 • Assessment lead: One teacher required two supporting examples, while the other accepted one well-developed example under the same wording.

03 • Department head: That identifies the observed difference more clearly than saying the teachers grade unfairly.

04 • Assessment lead: Yes. The effect is inconsistent guidance, but we haven't yet reviewed every affected mark.

05 • Department head: Could we compare anonymized examples together and agree how the rubric wording should be interpreted?

06 • Assessment lead: That would support calibration, meaning a shared understanding of how to apply the criteria.

07 • Department head: Please check the grading policy before proposing any changes to marks or communicating a correction.

08 • Assessment lead: Agreed. The review should distinguish interpretation, any verified marking effect, and the authorized response.

09 • Department head: I'll arrange a focused professional-development discussion with both teachers rather than attribute motives to either.

10 • Assessment lead: I'll bring the rubric and examples so the next action addresses the specific observed inconsistency.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An observation note needs a concrete behavior

Fictional faculty feedback: an observation note says a teacher did not engage learners; the observer recorded no learner counts but noted one unanswered invitation to speak.

01 • Faculty mentor: Your observation note says learners were disengaged. What specific behavior supports that description?

02 • Observer: I noted one invitation to speak followed by silence, but I didn't record broader participation counts.

03 • Faculty mentor: Then the note should not turn that single moment into a conclusion about every learner.

04 • Observer: I can describe the invitation and silence without claiming I know why nobody responded.

05 • Faculty mentor: Exactly. Explain the effect you observed and invite the teacher's perspective before proposing improvement.

06 • Observer: Would asking about wait time and alternative ways to participate be a constructive next step?

07 • Faculty mentor: Yes, as questions for professional development, not proof that a specific teaching approach failed.

08 • Observer: I'll revise the observation language and discuss that moment with the teacher privately.

09 • Faculty mentor: Keep any formal evaluation conclusion within the applicable process and supported evidence.

10 • Observer: Understood. My feedback will name the observed event, acknowledge its limits, and invite a practical discussion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Different feedback at the same rubric level

Fictional marking review: two teachers awarded the same rubric level, but one wrote needs more evidence and the other wrote explain your examples.

01 • Course coordinator: Both teachers awarded the same level, but students heard different advice about how to improve.

02 • Assessment specialist: One comment requests more evidence; the other asks learners to explain existing examples. Those imply different actions.

03 • Course coordinator: Does that establish different grading standards, or only a feedback-language inconsistency in these examples?

04 • Assessment specialist: Neither is established yet; different work may need different advice at the same level.

05 • Course coordinator: Then we should check whether each comment matches the needs shown in the corresponding work.

06 • Assessment specialist: Exactly. Let's compare each comment with the work and rubric criterion before deciding whether clarification is needed.

07 • Course coordinator: Could we model specific feedback during the next professional-development meeting using anonymized work?

08 • Assessment specialist: Yes. That makes the next action practical while protecting student information and avoiding personal blame.

09 • Course coordinator: I'll ask both teachers to explain their intended meaning before we propose any shared guidance.

10 • Assessment specialist: I'll bring the criterion and examples so the discussion stays grounded in the observed feedback.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Faculty Coordination and Evaluation

Two teachers use different interpretations of the same grading rubric. Students receive inconsistent explanations.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can explain a practical obstacle affecting the work. Share it after your partner asks for your perspective, then agree on one observable change.

Second round: The recipient disagrees with your interpretation. Return to the observed example, listen, and revise an unsupported assumption.

Model for scenario 1: Let's compare the descriptors against the same sample of work. Where do our interpretations differ? We can agree on clearer explanations and examples before using the rubric again.

Scenario 2 | A rubric level is explained as effort

A fictional rubric describes evidence quality, but one feedback comment explains a level as worked hard. The learner's work has not yet been reviewed by the coordinator. Discuss the mismatch without changing the grade prematurely.

Role A: Assessment coordinator: identify the difference between the criterion and the comment.

Role B: Teacher: clarify intended feedback and agree a work-based review.

Possible opening: The rubric addresses evidence quality, but this comment explains the level in terms of effort.

Success checks

- Describe the observable wording mismatch.
- Avoid inferring the grade is wrong without review.
- Agree a criterion-based feedback check.

Add a complication: A colleague asks you to change the grade before examining the work.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Compliance, Records, and Privacy

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A colleague asks for an entire student file for a narrow administrative task. The authorized scope is unclear.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

FERPA - Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act: a US federal law concerning education records and related rights.

student record - Information maintained about a student under applicable education-record rules.

need to know - A basis for limiting access to information required for an authorized purpose.

secure handling - Managing information or material through approved measures that protect it from unauthorized use or disclosure.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
 - B. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
 - C. Send it no later than Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?
 - B. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - C. Could you confirm that the review is important?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A narrow task does not establish full-file access

Fictional records request using the lesson case: a colleague asks for an entire student file for a narrow task, but authorized scope is unclear.

01 • Program administrator: Could you send the complete student record? I need to confirm one enrollment detail.

02 • Records officer: Please specify the detail and purpose so we can check the authorized scope and secure handling.

03 • Program administrator: Would being a school employee mean I can receive the whole file on a need-to-know basis?

04 • Records officer: Employment alone doesn't answer this request's scope. We should use the institution's access-review process.

05 • Program administrator: I only need the recorded enrollment date. I'll revise the request to that field.

06 • Records officer: Thank you. I'll verify authorization and the appropriate response channel rather than release unrelated information.

07 • Program administrator: Should I quote the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act, or FERPA, as automatic permission?

08 • Records officer: No. Refer applicability and interpretation to the authorized specialist; this conversation isn't a legal determination.

09 • Program administrator: I'll state the task and requested timing, with access pending the proper review.

10 • Records officer: I'll confirm what can be shared for that purpose and identify any remaining authorization question.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A spreadsheet export includes unnecessary fields

Fictional school administration: a room-allocation task needs class counts, but a proposed export includes student names and personal contact details.

01 • Timetabling officer: The export includes names and contact details. Do we need those for allocating classroom sizes?

02 • Records coordinator: The stated task needs class counts. Please confirm whether an aggregate report would meet the requirement.

03 • Timetabling officer: Yes, counts by class should answer that question. I don't need individual contact information.

04 • Records coordinator: Then I'll request the aggregate view through our records process instead of circulating the full export.

05 • Timetabling officer: Could I keep the full file anyway in case another administrative question comes up later?

06 • Records coordinator: That future purpose is unspecified. We should assess actual need to know and authorized handling, not hypothetical convenience.

07 • Timetabling officer: Understood. Please provide the approved counts before the room-planning discussion if the review allows it.

08 • Records coordinator: I'll request that timing and flag any delay without promising access before authorization is checked.

09 • Timetabling officer: I'll keep the planning request limited to class counts and avoid copying the personal fields elsewhere.

10 • Records coordinator: Good. The response can support the task while keeping unrelated student-record information outside its scope.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The requested recipient is not yet verified

Fictional records inquiry: an email asks a school to send a learner's attendance record to a new address; recipient authority is unverified.

01 • School secretary: An email asks for an attendance record at a new address. Can I send it immediately?

02 • Records officer: First use the established identity and authorization checks. The new recipient's authority hasn't been verified.

03 • School secretary: The message knows the learner's name. Does that establish permission to receive the student record?

04 • Records officer: No. Knowing a name doesn't establish access rights or the appropriate secure-handling route.

05 • School secretary: What should my reply request without asking the sender to email more sensitive information unnecessarily?

06 • Records officer: Direct them to the school's approved verification process and identify the records contact who handles it.

07 • School secretary: Should I promise delivery today if they reply quickly, even before the review is complete?

08 • Records officer: No. Acknowledge the request and its review status without guaranteeing an unconfirmed release time.

09 • School secretary: I'll keep the record restricted and explain that verification must occur before sharing.

10 • Records officer: Thank you. We'll assess the recipient and scope through the proper process rather than infer authorization from familiarity.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Compliance, Records, and Privacy

A colleague asks for an entire student file for a narrow administrative task. The authorized scope is unclear.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you identify the purpose and the specific records needed? Let's confirm the permitted access and sharing process before providing information from the file.

Scenario 2 | A printed roster left for collection

A fictional administrator wants to leave a student roster at an open reception desk for another staff member. The receiving person's authorization and approved collection method are unconfirmed. Request a secure-handling check before arranging collection.

Role A: Records coordinator: ask who needs the roster and for which task.

Role B: Office administrator: clarify the purpose and contact the authorized records owner.

Possible opening: Before leaving the roster for collection, could we confirm the recipient's need and the approved handover method?

Success checks

- Separate packaging from authorization and secure handling.
- Request the specific recipient and purpose.
- Keep handover pending the applicable review.

Add a complication: The administrator says an envelope alone proves the arrangement is appropriate.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Accreditation and Program Review

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

A program review action plan lists five actions. Three are complete, one is underway, and one has no assigned owner.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

accreditation - External recognition that an organization meets defined quality, safety, or professional standards.

program review - A structured evaluation of a program's design, results, and opportunities for improvement.

evidence - Information that supports or challenges a claim or conclusion.

action plan - A set of steps, responsibilities, and dates for achieving an objective.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team plans to complete the review.
 - B. The team has completed the review.
 - C. The team is completing the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.
 - B. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.
 - C. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Three complete, one underway, one without an owner

Fictional program review using the lesson case: an action plan has five actions; three are complete, one is underway, and one has no owner.

01 • Program director: How should we summarize the five-action plan for the program-review meeting without overstating progress?

02 • Accreditation coordinator: Three actions are complete, one is underway, and one still has no assigned owner.

03 • Program director: Could we describe the plan as substantially closed because most actions are finished?

04 • Accreditation coordinator: That wording could hide the unowned action. State the actual categories and explain the remaining accountability gap.

05 • Program director: Do we have authority to assign the missing owner in this meeting, or must someone else decide?

06 • Accreditation coordinator: That needs confirmation. We should ask the responsible lead rather than put a name in without agreement.

07 • Program director: Please link the completed actions to their evidence so the review can verify the progress.

08 • Accreditation coordinator: I will, while keeping the underway item separate from work merely planned.

09 • Program director: Our decision ask will be to confirm ownership and the next checkpoint for the unfinished work.

10 • Accreditation coordinator: Good. That provides a useful status without implying the whole action plan or accreditation process is complete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Evidence uploaded, review still pending

Fictional accreditation preparation: a department uploaded evidence files, but the review team has not assessed their coverage or relevance.

01 • Department administrator: The evidence files are uploaded. Can we mark the accreditation evidence requirement as satisfied?

02 • Review coordinator: Upload is complete, but the reviewers haven't assessed relevance or coverage against the requested criteria.

03 • Department administrator: Then accessible files and accepted evidence are different milestones in this preparation process.

04 • Review coordinator: Correct. We should report the submission and keep the assessment outcome pending.

05 • Department administrator: Should I assume the reviewers agree if they don't comment before the next update?

06 • Review coordinator: No. Silence isn't confirmation of review or acceptance. Request a status through the agreed coordination route.

07 • Department administrator: I'll identify the submitted file versions and ask whether any access or evidence gaps have been found.

08 • Review coordinator: Good. Don't replace files silently while the review is underway; preserve clear version references.

09 • Department administrator: The update will say submission complete, coverage assessment pending, and reviewer response requested.

10 • Review coordinator: That gives the program team accurate progress without turning document availability into a completed accreditation judgment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An action was performed, its effect is unassessed

Fictional program-review action: a revised orientation session was delivered, but the planned learner-feedback review has not occurred.

01 • Program lead: We delivered the revised orientation. Can we say the action has improved learner understanding?

02 • Quality coordinator: Delivery is complete, but the planned feedback review hasn't occurred, so the effect remains unassessed.

03 • Program lead: Then the action plan should distinguish implementation from the evidence of its intended benefit.

04 • Quality coordinator: Exactly. A completed session doesn't establish how learners understood or used the information.

05 • Program lead: Could we still recognize the staff's completed work without claiming an outcome we haven't checked?

06 • Quality coordinator: Yes. Report the session delivered and identify the feedback review as the next pending step.

07 • Program lead: I'll ask the evaluation owner to confirm when the available feedback can be reviewed.

08 • Quality coordinator: Please avoid inventing a response rate or positive result before the evidence is examined.

09 • Program lead: The program-review update will retain both the completed activity and the open effectiveness question.

10 • Quality coordinator: Good. That makes the improvement process traceable and keeps the evidence claim within what is actually known.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Accreditation and Program Review

A program review action plan lists five actions. Three are complete, one is underway, and one has no assigned owner.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: Three actions are complete and one is underway. The fifth needs an owner and a target date. I'll make that outstanding decision visible in the program review update.

Scenario 2 | The action owner has changed roles

A fictional program-review action remains open. Its named owner has moved to another department, and no replacement has accepted responsibility. The action's deadline is next month. Give a status update and request ownership clarification.

Role A: Quality coordinator: explain the confirmed owner change and open responsibility.

Role B: Program director: ask what decision is needed without assuming the action is abandoned.

Possible opening: The action remains open, and its named owner has changed roles; replacement ownership is not yet confirmed.

Success checks

- Separate ownership maintenance from completion.
- State the existing deadline without inventing progress.
- Request a confirmed owner and follow-up checkpoint.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests marking the action complete to remove the outdated name.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Budget, Staffing, and Institutional Priorities

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

SITUATION

A department can open another class by reallocating staff or hiring temporary support. Each option affects workload differently.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

budget - An approved or proposed financial plan for a defined period or activity.

staffing model - A plan or calculation describing the roles and staffing needed for a service or workload.

workload - The amount and type of work assigned or required over a period.

sustainability - The ability to maintain an activity over time while addressing relevant resource, social, or environmental effects.

3. Notice the language

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Compare this wording: This option is more better.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Explain a fair comparison

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence expresses a clear contrast?
 - A. Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.
 - B. Option A is faster because option B costs less.
 - C. Option A is faster, so option B costs less.
2. A rate increases from 6% to 7%. What is the absolute difference?
 - A. An increase of one percent relative to the original rate.
 - B. An increase of seven percentage points.
 - C. An increase of one percentage point.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Reallocate a teacher or hire temporary support

Separate fictional staffing case: another class needs six teaching hours weekly. Reallocation would remove six tutoring hours; temporary support would preserve tutoring but require budget approval and hiring. Neither option is approved.

01 • Department head: We need six weekly teaching hours for another class. Which staffing model should we propose?

02 • Finance administrator: Reallocation removes six tutoring hours; temporary support preserves them but needs funding and hiring.

03 • Department head: Could we call reallocation free because it doesn't require a new salary line?

04 • Finance administrator: It still has a workload and service tradeoff. Lost tutoring time matters alongside the budget impact.

05 • Department head: Then compare cost, tutoring coverage, recruitment timing, and workload using the same criteria.

06 • Finance administrator: Agreed. Hiring timing is unknown, so we shouldn't present temporary support as immediately available.

07 • Department head: I prefer preserving tutoring if funding and suitable staffing can be confirmed. Otherwise we need another review.

08 • Finance administrator: That is a conditional preference, not an approved staffing commitment or a guaranteed sustainable solution.

09 • Department head: I'll discuss tutoring impact with staff and take the temporary-support request to the budget owner.

10 • Finance administrator: I'll clarify the funding position so the decision includes both workload consequences and unresolved hiring conditions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A one-term grant does not establish recurring funding

Fictional school planning: one-term funding could support an additional workshop group; funding for later terms is unconfirmed.

01 • Program coordinator: The grant covers one term. Can we announce the additional workshop group as a permanent service?

02 • Budget manager: Not yet. Later funding is unconfirmed, so permanence would go beyond the current budget position.

03 • Program coordinator: Could we compare a one-term pilot with waiting until recurring support is secured?

04 • Budget manager: Yes. The pilot offers earlier access but needs clear limits; waiting delays access but avoids a premature recurring commitment.

05 • Program coordinator: We should also compare staffing workload and what happens to learners when the funded term ends.

06 • Budget manager: Agreed. Sustainability includes continuity and staff capacity, not just whether this term's expenditure is covered.

07 • Program coordinator: I favor assessing a bounded pilot, provided the end-of-term arrangements are reviewed and communicated clearly.

08 • Budget manager: I'll check the grant conditions with the responsible owner rather than assume every proposed use is allowed.

09 • Program coordinator: I'll consult the staffing lead and keep future terms explicitly uncommitted in the proposal.

10 • Budget manager: Then the decision can consider immediate benefit and continuation risk using the actual funding boundary.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Combine groups or add a session

Separate fictional program case: two groups of 10 learners share a subject. Combining them fits the room's stated capacity of 20; an extra session requires two additional staff hours. Learning and workload effects are unassessed.

01 • Scheduling lead: Could we combine the two ten-learner groups instead of adding a session with two extra staff hours?

02 • Program head: The room holds twenty, but room capacity alone doesn't establish the learning or workload effects.

03 • Scheduling lead: Then we should compare staffing hours, learner support, timetable feasibility, and educational suitability for both options.

04 • Program head: Yes. Combining avoids the additional session hours, but we haven't assessed support demands in the larger group.

05 • Scheduling lead: And adding a session preserves group size but needs staff availability that isn't confirmed.

06 • Program head: Correct. Neither option should be called sustainable based only on the number of scheduled hours.

07 • Scheduling lead: Could we ask the teachers to assess support needs while the staffing owner checks availability?

08 • Program head: That's a practical next step. It brings the affected staff into the comparison before a decision.

09 • Scheduling lead: I'll report both options with those pending checks rather than announce a combined group today.

10 • Program head: Good. We'll choose after reviewing the educational and workload tradeoff, not simply the room count.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Budget, Staffing, and Institutional Priorities

A department can open another class by reallocating staff or hiring temporary support. Each option affects workload differently.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: Reallocation uses existing staff but changes their workload; temporary support adds cost and preparation needs. Let's compare the implications for learners and staff before choosing an option.

Scenario 2 | Extend office hours or redistribute them

A fictional student office wants two extra evening hours weekly. One option shifts two existing morning hours; another adds paid hours. Morning demand, staff availability, and added funding are unconfirmed. Compare options for a bounded staffing proposal.

Role A: Office manager: explain the two coverage options.

Role B: Budget coordinator: ask about workload, service effects, and approval.

Possible opening: We can assess shifting two morning hours or adding paid evening hours, but the demand and staffing checks are still open.

Success checks

- Compare the same coverage and workload criteria.
- Name reduced morning service as a possible tradeoff, not a measured harm.
- Keep funding and staffing commitments conditional.

Add a complication: A colleague calls shifted hours cost-free without considering reduced morning access.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Enrollment, Admissions, and Placement

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: B - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

B: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

C: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

Check 2: A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

B: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

C: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

Model response: I can explain the published criteria and the next steps available for this application. Which part of the decision notice would you like me to clarify? I cannot discuss another applicant's record.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Curriculum Planning and Learning Outcomes

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

B: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

C: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

Check 2: C - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

B: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

C: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

Model response: A topic says what we cover; an outcome says what learners should be able to do. Let's define those performances first, then check whether the assessment gives learners a chance to demonstrate them.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Student Support and Intervention

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: C - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

B: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

C: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

Check 2: B - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

B: The requested action and information are explicit.

C: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

Model response: Could you bring the relevant attendance pattern and the support actions already attempted? We can use those records to plan the discussion and avoid repeating an approach without reviewing its effect.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Parent and Guardian Communication

Editing example: I'm sorry my message did not explain the timing clearly.

The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Check 1: B - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.

A: This acknowledges a missed date, not the communication problem in the question.

B: This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.

C: This acknowledges duration, but does not take responsibility for the unclear wording.

Check 2: A - The corrected date and the current confirmation status.

A: A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

B: The reader still lacks the information they need.

C: An unsupported new promise can create a second misunderstanding.

Model response: I'm sorry the wording sounded accusatory. The purpose is to understand the late arrivals and discuss support. Could we arrange a time to review the pattern and hear your perspective?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Faculty Coordination and Evaluation

Editing example: The last two reports omitted the agreed summary section.

The revision identifies observable work. 'Always' and a personality judgment make the feedback harder to verify or act on.

Check 1: A - The last two updates omitted the agreed completion date.

A: The recipient can check the specific examples and discuss how to improve them.

B: "Less professional" is an evaluation; it does not identify a specific observable omission.

C: Commitment is an interpretation, not a description of what the updates contained.

Check 2: C - What is making this part of the task difficult?

A: A promise does not reveal the obstacle or what support would help.

B: This proposes a solution before finding out what is making the task difficult.

C: An open question may reveal a barrier the speaker has not considered.

Model response: Let's compare the descriptors against the same sample of work. Where do our interpretations differ? We can agree on clearer explanations and examples before using the rubric again.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Compliance, Records, and Privacy

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: C - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

B: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

C: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

Check 2: B - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

B: The requested action and information are explicit.

C: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

Model response: Could you identify the purpose and the specific records needed? Let's confirm the permitted access and sharing process before providing information from the file.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Accreditation and Program Review

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: B - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

B: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

C: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

Check 2: A - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

B: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

C: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

Model response: Three actions are complete and one is underway. The fifth needs an owner and a target date. I'll make that outstanding decision visible in the program review update.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Budget, Staffing, and Institutional Priorities

Editing example: This option is better on cost, but slower to deliver.

'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Check 1: A - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.

A: 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.

B: 'Because' claims a causal connection that is not given.

C: 'So' implies one fact causes the other.

Check 2: C - An increase of one percentage point.

A: A one-percent relative increase on 6% would be 6.06%, not 7%.

B: The new rate is 7%; the difference between the rates is one percentage point.

C: Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

Model response: Reallocation uses existing staff but changes their workload; temporary support adds cost and preparation needs. Let's compare the implications for learners and staff before choosing an option.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

US Department of Education: FERPA

<https://studentprivacy.ed.gov/ferpa>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Education Administration English

Professional audience: school administrators, curriculum coordinators, student-services staff, program directors, admissions teams, registrars, and education operations leaders

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Enrollment, Admissions, and Placement

Original fictional case: A family asks why an applicant was not offered a place. The administrator needs to explain the published process without discussing other applicants.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: admissions criteria: The stated requirements used to assess applications for entry to a program. / placement: Assigning a learner to a suitable level or program using relevant evidence. / capacity: Available people, assets, time, space, or system throughput for a given workload. / equity: Fairness in access or treatment; in finance, ownership interest or residual value.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: I can explain the published criteria and the next steps available for this application. Which part of the decision notice would you like me to clarify? I cannot discuss another applicant's record.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level